

Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-06-19

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Corinthians 16:13-24

13 Watch, stand fast in the faith, be brave, be strong.

14 Let all that you do be done with love.

15 I urge you, brethren—you know the household of Stephanas, that it is the firstfruits of Achaia, and that they have devoted themselves to the ministry of the saints—

16 that you also submit to such, and to everyone who works and labors with us.

17 I am glad about the coming of Stephanas, Fortunatus, and Achaicus, for what was lacking on your part they supplied.

18 For they refreshed my spirit and yours. Therefore acknowledge such men.

19 The churches of Asia greet you. Aquila and Priscilla greet you heartily in the Lord, with the church that is in their house.

20 All the brethren greet you. Greet one another with a holy kiss.

21 The salutation with my own hand—Paul's.

22 If anyone does not love the Lord Jesus Christ, let him be accursed. O Lord, come!

23 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you.

24 My love be with you all in Christ Jesus. Amen.

II. Key Summary

- Paul closes with four commands — "Watch, stand fast in the faith, be brave, be strong" — all in military language, calling believers to stay alert and hold firm in their faith.
- Paul immediately adds a fifth command: "Let all that you do be done with love," making love the governing principle behind all the strength and vigilance just described.
- In his personal closing, Paul says "If anyone does not love the Lord Jesus Christ, let him

be accursed" — making love for the Lord the ultimate test of genuine faith — and ends the entire letter with blessing and love.

III. Passage Analysis

Watch, Stand, Be Strong — Hold Your Ground, Not Launch an Attack

"The commands ring sharp and short like pistol-shots — the first four are entirely martial in tone, like sending soldiers into battle." [1]

Paul uses military language to describe what faith looks like in practice: watch (don't let your guard down), stand fast (hold your position, don't break ranks), be brave (don't flinch when attacked), be strong (reinforce each other, keep the line). This isn't a call to go picking fights — it's a call to know where you stand and refuse to be moved from it.

Strength and Gentleness Aren't Opposites — Paul Puts Them in the Same Breath

"The strongest type of human character is the gentlest and most loving. Strength and tenderness are united in Christ." [2]

Right after "be strong," Paul says "let all that you do be done with love." This isn't a pivot — it's a completion. Strength without love is just stubbornness. Love is what gives strength its purpose and direction, and tells you what's worth holding on to.

IV. Reflection Question

Have you ever faced a situation where you knew you should speak up or stand firm, but were afraid of hurting someone, and didn't know how to do both at once?

Paul says "be strong" and "let all that you do be done with love" — for him, these two things don't cancel each other out. They're meant to exist in the same person at the same time.

References

[1] BibleHub.com, MacLaren's Expositions,

https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/1_corinthians/16-13.htm

[2] BibleHub.com, MacLaren's Expositions,

https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/1_corinthians/16-14.htm